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FUZZY LEVANE

Coach was a fixture of the NYC basketball scene

LARRY C. MORRIS / THE NEW YORK TIMES

Andrew “Fuzzy” Levane coached the New York Knicks in the late 1950s.

Fuzzy Levane, who as a high school and college star and as a coach and scout for the Knicks was a fixture of New York City basketball for a half-century, died April 30 in Irmo, S.C. He was 92.

The cause was heart failure, his son Lawrence said.

A personable and gregarious figure, Levane was head coach of the Knicks during the 1958-59 season, leading them to a 40-32 record, a second-place finish in the NBA's Eastern Division and a playoff appearance, though he resigned under pressure early in the 1959 season after the team lost 19 of its first 27 games.

His biggest contribution to the franchise was probably his hiring of a scout, a long-time friend named Red Holzman, who would later coach the Knicks to their only league championships, in 1970 and 1973.

The two had known each other since their Brooklyn schoolboy days, when Holzman played for Franklin K. Lane High School and Levane was a star on the James Madison team that won the city championship in 1939. From then on, their careers were entwined.

Both played college ball in the city, Holzman at City College and Levane at St. John's, where he was named player of the year in the New York area in 1943 and led his team to the National Invitation Tournament title. They were teammates in pro ball with the Rochester Royals of the National Basketball League, a precursor of the NBA

Levane, whose career was hampered by a congenital heart defect, played one season, 1949-50, in the NBA, for the Syracuse Nationals. He also played a handful of games for the Milwaukee Hawks in the 1952-53 season, his first as their coach. In his second year he recruited Holzman to play for him. (Holzman had remained with Rochester after it joined the NBA.) When Levane was later dismissed, Holzman replaced him, beginning his Hall of Fame coaching career.

After his stint with the Knicks, Levane returned to NBA coaching for one season, 1961-62, with his old team, the Hawks, by then in St. Louis. When Holzman became coach of the Knicks in 1967, he hired his old friend as a scout, essentially reversing their roles. Holzman, who died in 1998, never forgot his debt to Levane.

“Blame me on Fuzzy,” he said after his Knicks won each of their championships.

Andrew Joseph Levane was born April 11, 1920, and grew up mostly in Brooklyn, though his family lived for a time in northern New Jersey. His father, Antonio, an immigrant from Naples, Italy, played the double bass in the Metropolitan Opera orchestra, and all five Levane children were expected to learn music.

Young Fuzzy — his nickname dates to his teenage years, when a friend of a cousin began calling him Cuzzy and someone else mispronounced it — found a basketball more interesting than a cello or a saxophone, both of which his father had foisted on him.

“I'd practice for an hour or so — I did learn some notes — and then duck out to play ball,” Levane said in an interview with *The New York Times*, recalling that his father would yell at him in broken English: “Andrew, if you don't learn something, you gonna be a bum. Stop with the ball!”

His father eventually came around, he said, especially after he earned a scholarship to St. John's.

Levane continued working as a Knick scout into his seventies. In the early '90s he brought Anthony Mason, then playing with the Long Island Surf of the now defunct United States Basketball League, to the attention of the Knicks. Mason became a key player on several strong Knick squads, including the 1994 team that lost to the Houston Rockets in the NBA finals.

Levane's wife, Kay, died in 2009. In addition to his son Lawrence, Levane, who lived in Irmo, is survived by another son, Andrew; three daughters, Denise Kennedy, Theresa Van Lierop and Linda Forbes; a sister, Lucy Kay; 14 grandchildren; and eight great-grandchildren.

New York Times

GEORGE LINDSEY

Actor played Goober on Andy Griffith

George Lindsey, the Alabama-born actor and comedian best known for playing the good-natured if none-too-bright gas station attendant Goober on three television series, died on Sunday in Nashville. He was 83.

His death was announced by the Marshall Donnelly Combs Funeral Home in Nashville. Lindsey had been in poor health after a stroke in March.

He introduced the character of Goober — the quintessential grinning hayseed, equal parts annoying and endearing — on *The Andy Griffith Show*, the long-running situation comedy set in the fictional North Carolina town of Mayberry. When Jim Nabors' character, the similarly likable but naive Gomer Pyle, was given his own series in 1964, Lindsey joined the Griffith show as Goober Pyle, Gomer's cousin.

Goober outlived *The Andy Griffith Show* by many years. When Griffith left after the 1967-68 season to pursue a movie career, the setting and some of the characters were retained, and the show was reinvented as *Mayberry R.F.D.*, with Ken Berry as the star. Lindsey was one of several actors who continued in their old roles.

The character later found yet another home. Shortly after *Mayberry R.F.D.* was cancelled in 1971, Lindsey joined the cast of *Hee Haw*, the syndicated variety show that blended country music and hokey comedy. He was once again a goofy gas station attendant, and he once again wore the beanie that was Goober's trademark, although his castmates usually addressed him on camera as George. He remained with *Hee Haw* for more than 20 years.

George Smith Lindsey was born in Fairfield, Ala., on Dec. 17, 1928, the only child of George Ross Lindsey and the former Alice Smith, and grew up in Jasper, Ala. (Many sources wrongly give the year of his birth as 1935.) He attended Florence State Teachers College, now the University of North Alabama, where he played quarterback on the football team and acted in campus theatrical productions, and graduated in 1952 with a degree in biology and physical education.

After spending three years in the U.S. Air Force he moved to New York, where he studied at the American Theater Wing and performed as a comedian in local nightclubs. In 1962 he appeared on Broadway in the short-lived musical *All American*, but his acting career did not gain momentum until he and his family moved to Los Angeles, where he was soon appearing on *Gunsmoke*, *The Twilight Zone*, *Alfred Hitchcock Presents* and other television shows.

Lindsey, who had lived in Nashville for many years, is survived by his companion, Anne Wilson; his son, George Jr.; his daughter, Camden Jo Lindsey Gardner; and two grandsons. His marriage to Joyanne Herbert ended in divorce.

The character of Goober was not to everyone's taste. Some critics considered Lindsey's portrayal of a rural Southerner a demeaning caricature. Lindsey disagreed.

“Goober is every man,” he told The Associated Press in 1985. “Everyone finds something to like about ol' Goober.”

The New York Times

FREDERICK M. BROWN / GETTY IMAGES

George Lindsey is shown here at a 2004 awards show.

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BERGSON, L*
HENDERSON, M*
MACTINGER, M*
TAMAN, M*

New notices are marked by an *
Notices may not appear alphabetically due to space requirements.

Funeral Directories

Benjamin's Park Memorial Chapel

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MONDAY
MOSLEY, Leah
1:00 Chapel

TUESDAY
BERGSON, Lilia
10:00 Pardes Shalom Cemetery

WEDNESDAY
KALMANOVITCH, Moissei
10:00 Chapel

SHIVA
GOTTLIEB, Rose
77 Fairway Heights Drive, Thornhill, Ontario
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130 Oakcrest Avenue

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Funeral Directories

STEELES MEMORIAL CHAPEL

MONDAY
BLACK, Ian
Service in Montreal
NUDELMAN, Gail
11:00 a.m. Bathurst Lawn Cemetery.
KATZ, Zipora
12:00 noon Pardes Shalom Cemetery

TUESDAY
KATZMAN, Irvin
2:00 p.m. Bathurst Lawn Cemetery, Beth David

WEDNESDAY
MacTINGER, Mary
11:00 a.m. Chapel

SHIVA
PRICE, Carol
Shiva private
BURGER, Suzanne Roberta
629 Vesta Dr.
DAYHIN, Oleg
Shiva private
OZIEL, Solomon
Shiva private
KATES, Harold
92 Roseborough Cres., Thornhill
ALMASSY, George
Shiva private
BLACK, Ian
Shiva in Montreal
NUDELMAN, Gail
37 Bayel Cres., Richmond Hill
KATZ, Zipora
Shiva at Temple Har Zion

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Obituaries

HENDERSON, Margaret
June 4, 1931 – May 4, 2012

Margaret Ann Henderson (nee Maxwell) of Ottawa and Mississauga succumbed after a 31 year battle with cancer. Devoted wife, loving mother, compassionate nurse, visionary teacher, gifted artisan and gardener. Deeply missed by husband David, children Elizabeth, Joan, Janet, and Ruth, and grandchildren Andrew, David, Jennifer, Ashley, Marc, Marjorie and Aaron. Funeral Service at Southminster United Church, Ottawa, 10:30am May 9th. Donations in lieu of flowers to Princess Margaret Hospital Foundation.

MACTINGER, Mary
05/07/2012

On Monday, May 7, 2012 at North York General Hospital. Mary Mactinger beloved wife of the late Louis Mactinger. Loving mother and mother-in-law of Gloria and Norton Medine, Martin Mactinger, and Karen Liberman and David Goldman. Cherished grandmother of Ruth and Len, Paul and Sue, Elana and Jeff, Jordan and Ann Marie, Matthew and Jonathan. Great-grandmother of Jason, Danny, Stephanie, Alex, Eli, Strachan, Noah, and Ethan. Special thanks to the staff at Thorne Mills on Steeles for their tremendous kindness. She will be sadly missed by all who knew her. At Steeles Memorial Chapel, 350 Steeles Ave. West, for service on Wednesday, May 9, 2012 at 11:00 a.m. Interment: Beth Shalom Synagogue section of Mount Sinai Memorial Park. Shiva: 16 Caravan Dr. Shiva visits from 1:00 p.m. to 5:00 p.m. and 7:00 to 9:00 p.m., evening services at 8:00 p.m. Memorial donations may be made to the Association for Soldiers of Israel 416-783-3053.

Obituaries

BERGSON, Lilia

On Monday, May 7, 2012 at North York General Hospital. Beloved wife of the late Maxwell Bergson. Loving mother and mother-in-law of Jana and Menachem Ailenberg, and Paym Bergson. Dear sister and sister-in-law of Rose and the late Charles Lerner. Devoted grandmother of Kobi, Tamar, Mandy, and Justin. Loving Aunt to her niece and nephew. A graveside service will be held on Tuesday, May 8th at 10:00 a.m., in the Adath Israel Synagogue Section of Pardes Shalom Cemetery, 10953 Dufferin St. (north of Major Mackenzie Dr.). Memorial donations may be made to the Heart and Stroke Foundation of Ontario at 1-888-473-4636 or to North York General Hospital Foundation at 416-756-6944.

TAMAN, Mildred Winona
(nee McDonell)

Passed away in Listowel on Saturday, April 28, 2012 at the age of 100 years. Mildred was the beloved wife of the late Edward "Ted" Taman, and mother of Toni Henry of Listowel and Dr. Sara Taman of Toronto. She will be sadly missed by her son-in-law Dr. R. Michael Shier and by her grandchildren Dr. E. Cortney Shier (and his wife Dr. Trishia Goodman) of Prince George BC, Jeremy Taman Shier of Vancouver, BC and R. Adam Shier and Ashleigh Shier of Toronto, and by her great-grandson Benjamin Shier. She was predeceased by her son-in-law Ron Henry, by her sisters Elizabeth Laughton and Dorothy McDonell, and by her brother Allan McDonell. Friends may call at the Eaton Funeral Home, Listowel on Wednesday, May 9 from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. A memorial service will be held at Trinity United Church, Listowel on Thursday, May 10 at 1:30 p.m. Interment in Fairview Cemetery, Listowel. Memorial donations to Canadian Cancer Society would be appreciated. Online condolences may be left at www.eatonfuneralhome.ca

In Memoriams

BELMORE, Bud
December 16, 1925 - May 8, 2011

Greatly missed and in our hearts everyday, you are never forgotten.
Love, Marg & family.

Right to the point.
NATIONAL POST

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